

PDF Studio

Easy Guide — reading, filling in, and signing documents

Version 3.2.0-alpha12

Making it comfortable to read

Do this first. It changes the whole program, and it remembers your choice.

To make the text and buttons bigger

1. Click View at the top.
2. Point to Appearance.
3. Under Text Size, choose Large or Extra Large.

To switch between light and dark

1. Click View, then point to Appearance.
2. Choose High-Contrast Light (black text on white) or Dark Industrial (light text on black).

Try both. Some people find the dark screen easier on the eyes; others prefer the light one. There is no wrong answer — pick whichever you can read most comfortably. The program will remember it next time.

To make the page itself bigger: click Zoom + on the toolbar, or hold Ctrl and roll the mouse wheel.

Opening a document

When PDF Studio starts, its red startup picture appears for about five seconds. This is normal. The main window opens automatically when the picture fades away.

The easy way: if PDF Studio is your default PDF app, double-click any PDF file. Otherwise use Open with  PDF Studio or open the file from inside the program.

From inside the program: click Open on the toolbar, at the top-left.

You can also open Word documents and Excel spreadsheets. They may take a few seconds to appear — that is normal.

Moving around a document

To do this	Do this
Go to the next page	Click Next, or press the right arrow key
Go back a page	Click Prev, or press the left arrow key
Jump to a page	Type the page number in the toolbar box, press Enter
Make the page bigger	Click Zoom +
Make the page smaller	Click Zoom -
Fit the whole page	Click Fit Pg
Fit the width	Click Fit W
Find a word	Click Search, type the word, press Enter

The panel on the left shows the Contents, your Bookmarks, any notes, any form fields, and small pictures of each page. Click a page picture or form field to jump straight to it.

If the window is narrow, some right-hand toolbar groups move under More ». Nothing has disappeared; widen the window and the groups return to the toolbar.

Filling in a form

When a PDF already has fillable boxes, PDF Studio outlines them in light blue and opens a Forms section on the left.

1. Click a field and type your answer.
2. Tick boxes, choose radio buttons, or select from drop-down and list fields.
3. Double-click a field in the Forms panel when you want PDF Studio to jump to it.
4. Click Save when finished. A * beside the name means changes are not saved yet.

The Forms panel can Reset Page, Reset All, or turn the blue highlights off.

Flatten Form to Copy... makes a separate finished copy that cannot be edited accidentally. Your original fillable PDF stays untouched.

Let PDF Studio suggest the fields

For many scanned forms, PDF Studio can make a careful first guess.

1. Open the Forms section on the left.
2. Under Smart Form Detection, leave the setting on Balanced.
3. Click Detect Current Page....
4. A large review window opens. Select each row to match it with the coloured box on the page.

5. Untick anything that looks wrong. The table shows the type, label, confidence, and reason for every suggestion.
6. Click Create Checked, then confirm.
7. If you close the window, use Review Suggestions... in Forms to reopen it.
8. Use Design mode to move or resize anything that needs adjustment.
9. Save the PDF.

Nothing is added until you approve it. Clear removes the suggestions without changing the document. Try More suggestions for a difficult page or High confidence for a stricter result.

Make a scanned form fillable manually

A scanned paper form starts as a picture. Form Designer can add real interactive fields to it.

1. Open the Forms section and tick Design mode.
2. Pick Text Field, Checkbox, Dropdown, Date, Yes / No, Signature, or Initials.
3. Click or drag where the field belongs.
4. Click Select. Drag a field to move it, or drag the small square at its lower-right corner to resize it.
5. Click Properties... to name the field, make it required, or enter dropdown choices one per line.

6. Click Save, turn Design mode off, and fill the new form.

Keep the original scan as a backup. Signature and initials controls are unsigned PDF signature placeholders; PDF Studio does not yet apply certificate-backed signatures.

Correcting words or numbers in a scan

A scanned page is a picture. PDF Studio replaces a selected area rather than pretending the original letters are editable.

1. Click Edit Text in the EDIT SCAN group.
2. Drag a tight box around the word, number, or short line, then release the mouse button. The bottom status briefly says Selection captured.
3. A Preparing Scanned-Text Editor window then appears while PDF Studio reads only that selected area. This first version reads English automatically; for other languages, type the replacement manually.
4. Check the recognised text and type the corrected version.
5. Leave Auto fit on for automatic sizing. If you choose a number instead, PDF Studio uses that exact point size.
6. Choose Reversible white-out overlay for the safest correction, or permanent mode only when you are sure.
7. Click Apply Replacement.

The reversible choice keeps the original scan underneath, works with Ctrl+Z, and can be removed from Annotations. Permanent mode forces Save As under a new filename so the original remains safe.

If OCR cannot read the area or ends unexpectedly, the editor still opens so you can type the replacement manually.

Signing a document

You have two ways to add your signature. Both work the same once it is on the page — it becomes part of the document when you save.

Way 1 — Use a picture of your signature (recommended)

If you have a photo or scan of your signature saved on the computer:

The quickest way: simply drag the picture file onto the page and drop it where you want the signature to go. That's all — it is placed for you.

Or, using the button:

1. Click Signature on the toolbar.
2. Choose Import image file.
3. Click Choose image... and pick your signature picture.
4. Leave Remove white background ticked. This hides the white paper around your signature so only the ink shows.
5. Click Add Signature.

6. Click the spot on the page where the signature should go.

Way 2 — Draw it with the mouse

1. Click Signature on the toolbar.
2. Make sure Draw signature is selected.
3. Draw your signature in the white box using the mouse. If you don't like it, click Clear and try again.
4. Click Add Signature.
5. Click the spot on the page where it should go.

Then save it

Click Save. The signature is now part of the document.

Made a mistake? Press Ctrl + Z to undo it.

Marking up a document

Click any of these buttons on the toolbar, then use the mouse on the page:

- Note — click the page to leave a sticky note.
- Highlight — drag across text to highlight it.
- Underline — drag across text to underline it.
- Strikethrough — drag across text to cross it out.
- Draw — draw freely on the page with the mouse.
- Eraser — remove marks you have made.

The coloured colour button changes the colour.

When you are finished with a tool, press the Esc key (top-left of the keyboard) to put it down.

Remember to click Save when you are done.

Turning a PDF page into a picture

This is useful for posters, flyers, or any website that asks for a PNG or JPG instead of a PDF.

1. Open the PDF and go to the page you want.
2. Click File > Export As > Image Files....
3. Choose Current page.
4. Choose the picture type: PNG is the best default for posters and sharp text; JPEG is good for photos; WebP, TIFF, BMP, and static GIF are also available.
5. Leave the resolution at 300 DPI for a printable poster, or use 150 DPI for ordinary screen use.
6. Click Export, choose the filename, and save.

To convert several pages, choose All pages or type a range such as 1-3, 6. PDF Studio creates one numbered picture for each page. GIF files are static, not animated.

Saving and printing

To do this	Do this
Save your changes	Click Save, or press Ctrl + S
Save as a new file (keep the original)	File > Save As...
Check before you print	File > Print Preview...
Print	Click Print, or press Ctrl + P

Print Preview shows you exactly what will come out of the printer before you print it — a good way to avoid wasting paper.

If the title bar at the top shows a *, you have unsaved changes.

If something goes wrong

I made a mistake.

Press Ctrl + Z to undo. You can press it several times to undo more.

A message says Save Rollback Incomplete.

Stop and do not delete the recovery folder shown in the message. It contains original copies that may be needed to repair the save. Open Help > Diagnostics... and send Leon the report plus the recovery-folder location.

A message says Recovery Copies Still Present.

The new PDF was saved, but Windows could not remove a private original backup. Close antivirus, preview, synchronisation, or backup software that may be using the folder, then click Retry Deletion. Choose Open Recovery Folder to inspect the exact location. Do not treat a redaction as securely complete until PDF Studio confirms the copies were removed.

The text is too small to read.

See Making it comfortable to read at the start of this guide, and choose Extra Large.

I can't see the buttons clearly.

Try the other colour scheme: View > Appearance, and switch between High-Contrast Light and Dark Industrial.

The mouse is doing something odd on the page.

A marking tool is probably still switched on. Press the Esc key to put it down.

A Word document won't open.

It may take a few seconds — please wait. If it still won't open, the computer may need Microsoft Word or LibreOffice installed. Ask Leon.

Getting help with a problem

1. Click Help.
2. Click Diagnostics....

3. Click Copy Diagnostics and paste the report into your support message.

The report does not copy words or pictures from your PDF. It includes technical file paths, so look over it before sharing. Click Open Log Folder to find PDF Studio's bounded troubleshooting logs.

The most useful keys

Key	What it does
Ctrl + S	Save
Ctrl + Z	Undo
Ctrl + P	Print
Ctrl + F	Find a word
Left / Right arrows	Previous / next page
Ctrl + +	Bigger
Ctrl + -	Smaller
Esc	Put down the current tool

PDF Studio is free. There is nothing to buy, no trial, and nothing will ever expire.